Denis Faraci

Gameplay Systems Programmer

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SUMMARY

Gameplay Systems Programmer with 2+ years of experience in **Unreal Engine 5 (C++)** and **Unity (C#)**, specializing in scalable gameplay systems, AI architecture and reusable data-driven frameworks.

Shipped **3 games on Steam** and **various games on Itch.io**, including *Negative Edge*, showcased at **Gamescom** and **DevGAMM**, *Golem Rumble* a multiplayer PvP battle arena and *Weabot*, a singleplayer puzzle-adventure game.

SKILLS

- **Unreal Engine 5**: Gameplay systems programming in C++ and Blueprints, reusable gameplay framework, Gameplay Ability System, CommonUI, MassEntity, Unreal Insights, Replication, data-driven design and editor tools.
- **Unity**: Gameplay systems programming in C#, reusable gameplay framework, editor tools.
- **Game AI**: Behavior Trees, StateTree, Squad System, Perception System, GOAP System and other plugins, designed as reusable, data-driven AI systems.
- **Gameplay Systems**: Inventory, RPG mechanics, weapons, progression, save systems and achievements built as modular, reusable plugins.
- **Programming**: C++, C#, software architecture, memory management and performance optimization.
- **Networking & Services**: Unreal Replication, Mirror, Steamworks and Google Play Services.
- **Tools & Workflow**: Python automation, Unreal editor utilities, Git / Git-Flow, Jira, HacknPlan and CI/CD pipelines.
- **UI Programming**: Unreal UMG / Slate and Unity UI Toolkit.

EXPERIENCE

Villains Studio - Negative Edge — Gameplay Programmer *Unreal Engine 5.5* | *Nov 2024 – Jul 2026*

- Responsible for core systems such as: AI, inventory, weapons, RPG mechanics, UI, data management
- Created VGOAP, a performance-oriented GOAP framework featuring multithreaded planning and streamlined AI configuration, reused across multiple projects.
- Led gameplay architecture decisions, working closely with design, art and audio to solve implementation challenges.
- **Result:** showcased at **Gamescom** and **DevGAMM**; released on Steam.

Villains Studio - Golem Rumble — Gameplay Programmer *Unreal Engine 5.5* | *Mar 2026 – Apr 2026*

- Developed core gameplay systems including AI, UI, trap mechanics, netcode team management and gameplay flow for a multiplayer PvP project.
- Built a modular Battle Pass plugin with encrypted save data, cosmetic skin management and tutorial progression using a state machine.
- **Result:** Showcased at **IGDA**; released on Steam.

Independent - Weabot — Gameplay Programmer *Unreal Engine 5.3* | *Jan 2024 – Jul 2024*

- Designed gameplay architecture and built modular inventory, save system, AI, UI and quests system.
- Delivered reusable gameplay solutions in close collaboration with designers and artists.
- **Result:** released on Steam and Itch.io.

Independent - Self — Sole Programmer *Unreal Engine 5.4* | *Nov 2024 – Dec 2024*

- Sole programmer on the project: owned architecture, implementation of AI, character controls, UI, inventory and core mechanics.
- Created an inputs register system to drive the core horror mechanic.
- **Result:** showcased at **IGDA**; released on Itch.io.

EDUCATION

Event Horizon School *Oct 2022 – Oct 2025*

Game Programming course (1000+ hours) focused on Unity C# and Unreal Engine C++. **Final Grade: 30/30**

I.T.I.S. "C. Facchinetti" *Sep 2015 – Oct 2022*

Computer Science and Software Engineering program. **Final Grade: 94/100**

LANGUAGES

Italian – Native; **English** – B2 Professional working proficiency.

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